

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 16 (FINAL)

Termination Session – Review, Closure & Long-Term Maintenance

Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	RK (35 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	16 of 16 (Final)	Focus:	Termination, review & long-term maintenance

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

This is the final termination session. Client has made excellent, stable progress throughout the 16 sessions. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought remains low (~20%). He has developed strong, personalized tools and a clear relapse prevention plan. Today we will do a comprehensive review of progress since Session 1, celebrate achievements, finalize the relapse prevention plan, provide emotional closure, and formally end the main course of therapy while scheduling booster sessions.

SESSION START – OPENING & MOOD CHECK

Therapist: Good morning, RK. Today is our final session. How are you feeling as we begin?

Client: A bit emotional, to be honest. I feel proud of everything we've done, but I'll miss these sessions. At the same time, I also feel ready.

Therapist: That combination of pride, sadness, and readiness is very normal and healthy. We'll take time today to honor the work you've done and make sure you feel fully equipped moving forward.

COMPREHENSIVE PROGRESS REVIEW

Therapist: Let's take a moment to look back at where we started. When you first came in, your GAD-7 was 18 (severe anxiety) and your belief in "I have to be perfect or they will see I'm not good enough" was around 80%. Where are those numbers now?

Client: GAD-7 is around 6 now, and the old belief is down to about 20%. I sleep better, I'm not constantly worried, I enjoy work again, and my relationship with my wife has improved a lot. I actually feel like myself again.

Therapist: Those are profound changes. What do you think has been the single most important thing that helped create these changes?

Client: The behavioral experiments. Actually testing my fears in real life changed how I think more than anything else. The thought records and Worry Time helped too, but the experiments gave me real proof that the old belief wasn't true.

FINAL RELAPSE PREVENTION REVIEW

Therapist: Let's do one final review of your complete relapse prevention plan.

Early Warning Signs: Increased daily worry, returning to over-checking, sleep disturbance, avoiding social interactions, irritability with wife.

Top Coping Strategies: Balanced belief + thought records, Worry Time/Postponement, behavioral experiments, problem-solving steps, talking to wife, monthly maintenance experiments.

Action Plan if symptoms return: Increase use of tools for 1 week → Review Coping Card daily → If no improvement after 7–10 days or major impact on life → Contact for booster session.

Long-term Maintenance: Monthly self-check-ins + one maintenance behavioral experiment per month for the first 6 months.

Booster Sessions: One at 6 weeks and one at 3 months after today.

Therapist: This is a very complete and personalized plan. How confident do you feel about using it?

Client: I feel confident. I know what to watch for and exactly what to do if I need to.

EMOTIONAL CLOSURE

Therapist: As we come to the end of our work together, is there anything you want to say or ask?

Client: I just want to say thank you. You helped me see things differently and gave me tools that actually work. I feel like I have my life back.

Therapist: Thank you, RK. It has been a privilege to work with you. You did the hard work — showing up every week, doing the experiments, being honest, and practicing between sessions. The changes you've made are because of your effort. I'm very proud of you.

Client: That means a lot. I'll miss this, but I'm also ready.

FINAL WORDS & BOOSTER CONFIRMATION

Therapist: Before we end, let's confirm your booster sessions:

- ****Booster Session 1**:** 6 weeks from today
- ****Booster Session 2**:** 3 months from today

Therapist: You can always reach out earlier if needed. You now have everything you need to continue growing. I have complete confidence in you.

Client: Thank you. I'll see you in 6 weeks for the first booster.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Excellent, stable outcome after 16 sessions.
- Client has developed strong, personalized, and sustainable CBT skills.
- Belief in old core thought remains low (~20%) and stable.
- Comprehensive relapse prevention plan is clear, realistic, and personalized.
- Booster sessions scheduled (6 weeks + 3 months).
- Therapy successfully terminated with warmth, closure, and confidence in the client's long-term success.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.